

♦ never accumulating significant wealth.

Are their concerns realistic? Yes. Yet UAWs spend more time worrying about these issues than taking proactive steps to change their tendencies to overconsume and underinvest.

What type of person recently indicated that he was afraid and worried about the following two issues?

1. Experiencing a significant reduction in his standard of living.
2. Not having an income high enough to satisfy his family's purchasing habits.

Who is this person? Perhaps he is a mail carrier with two children in college. Or perhaps he is a single, low-income parent who has to raise three children. Do you envision a middle-aged corporate manager who recently found out that his position would be eliminated? Certainly these are logical guesses. People in these categories would very likely express fear about having to reduce their standard of living and not having the income to satisfy their family's buying habits. But none of these people is the one we are about to profile.

The respondent who actually expressed these fears and worries is a surgeon in his fifties whom we shall call Dr. South (see [Table 3-1](#)). He is married and has four children. Why should he be worried about his standard of living and his income? Could it be that he's down on his luck, perhaps unable to continue to practice medicine because of a disability? No. Actually he is a fine physician who earned more than \$700,000 during the year prior to our interview with him! But in spite of his high income, his net worth in real terms is declining. He has reasons to be afraid and worried.

Dr. North is very similar to Dr. South in age, income, and family composition. But Dr. North is a PAW. His profile is also detailed later in this chapter. Dr. North has far fewer worries than Dr. South. He is not afraid of being forced to reduce his standard of living. Unlike Dr. South, he is not concerned that his income will not be high enough to satisfy his family's purchasing habits. This is especially interesting given that both Dr. South and Dr. North have similar incomes. The case studies that follow will introduce you to these physicians and their families. You will learn a lot about how each man makes use of his time, energy, and money. But before we profile these two physicians in detail, we will